

Lessons in Thrift

A man who **prided** himself on his **thriftiness** was **dismayed** to learn that there was another **tightwad** who lived more **frugally** than him.

"I must take lessons in **thrift** from this genius," he said to his son, "otherwise I'll continue to overspend. Go to his house and ask him if he will accept me as his student!"

It was **customary** to gift a **goose** to the guru at the time he was **approached**. The would-be chela **drew** a fine goose on a piece of paper and gave it to his son.

"Give this to him with my **regards**," he **beamed**.

The boy **set off**, **thrilled** by his father's **ingenuity**. A true son of his father, the thought of giving away one of their **geese** had filled him with horror.

It took him half a day to arrive at his destination. The man he had come to meet was not at home, but his wife was there and she assured him that her husband would accept his father as his student.

The boy **dutifully handed over** the drawing of the goose to her. She took it and carefully placed it in a drawer.

It was customary for the teacher to **acknowledge** the gift with a lesser gift of his own.

"Please take these oranges for your father," she said, and **went through** the motions of handing over four oranges to him, picking them up, one by one from the table beside her. Only there were no oranges there at all. Her husband returned shortly after the boy had left.

She told him about the boy's visit, and the exchange of gifts.

"Good, good," said her husband. "We must not forget the social **graces**. But show me how you held the oranges."

When she showed him how she had held the imaginary oranges, her husband's **brow** darkened in anger.

"Oh, you wasteful woman!" he **shrieked**. "Did you have to hold your fingers so far apart?! Do you think we are millionaires that we can give away such BIG oranges!"



Vocabulary

1. **Pride** (verb) – boast, glory, revel, exult, vaunt गर्व करना
2. **Thriftiness** (noun) – frugality, economy, prudence, saving, parsimony मितव्ययिता
3. **Dismay** (verb) – appall, distress, shock, unsettle, horrify निराश करना
4. **Tightwad** (noun) – miser, skinflint, cheapskate, penny-pincher, hoarder कंजूस
5. **Frugally** (adverb) – economically, sparingly, thriftily, parsimoniously, prudently मितव्ययिता से
6. **Thrift** (noun) – economy, frugality, parsimony, prudence, saving बचत
7. **Customary** (adjective) – traditional, habitual, conventional, usual, established परंपरागत
8. **Goose** (noun) – waterfowl, gander, bird, poultry, fowl हंस
9. **Approach** (verb) – reach, come near, move toward, advance, near पास जाना
10. **Draw** (verb) – sketch, illustrate, outline, depict, trace चित्र बनाना
11. **Regard** (noun) – respect, esteem, consideration, admiration, appreciation सम्मान
12. **Beam** (verb) – smile, radiate, glow, grin, shine मुस्कुराना
13. **Set off** (phrasal verb) – depart, embark, leave, begin, start निकल पड़ना
14. **Thrill** (verb) – excite, exhilarate, electrify, elate, delight रोमांचित करना
15. **Ingenuity** (noun) – cleverness, creativity, inventiveness, originality, resourcefulness चतुराई
16. **Geese** (noun) – ganders, birds, fowl, poultry, waterfowl हंस (बहुवचन)
17. **Dutifully** (adverb) – obediently, respectfully, submissively, loyally, faithfully कर्तव्यपूर्वक
18. **Hand over** (phrasal verb) – deliver, transfer, present, give, submit सौंप देना
19. **Acknowledge** (verb) – recognize, admit, accept, respond, appreciate स्वीकार करना
20. **Go through** (phrasal verb) – perform, enact, undergo, experience, execute करना/गुजरना
21. **Grace** (noun) – elegance, courtesy, charm, decency, civility शिष्टाचार
22. **Brow** (noun) – forehead, temple, ridge, eyebrow, crest माथा
23. **Shriek** (verb) – scream, screech, yell, howl, wail चीखना

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